Electric hedge cutter

I complete a practical induction with an experienced member before my first solo use. I answer the corded or battery points that apply to my machine.

MY FULL NAME

DATE OF MY INDUCTION

MAKE / MODEL / ASSET NUMBER

MY EMAIL

First-aid kit location:

Site address / postcode:

Emergency entrance / access:

USING THIS CHECKLIST

I use the manual, ask questions and practise while the experienced member watches me check, handle, start, use and stop the machine. For each point, I tick Covered (I understand and have covered this), N/A or More help (I need more help). I explain N/A answers and record the task, limits and outcome we agree. If I need more help, I do not use the tool alone until the outstanding points are addressed and recorded.

#	SAFE-USE POINT - on the actual machine	Covered	N/A	More help
	MANUAL			
1	I have read and understood the instructions for this model, with help if needed. I know how to access the manual.			
	PPE			
2	I wear eye/face and hearing protection as required by the manual and task, together with gloves, sturdy boots and long trousers.			
3	I wear close-fitting clothes, tie back long hair and make sure nothing is dangling.			
	BEFORE I START			
4	I check that the teeth are undamaged and the blade bolts are tight. I keep the blade cover on until I am ready to cut.			
5	I check the hedge first for nests, wire, stakes, posts and cables. I do not cut in bird-nesting season, roughly March to August, unless the hedge has been checked and is clear.			
6	I make sure my footing is clear and keep both feet on the ground.			
	POWER			
7	I plug the machine in through a working RCD and press the test button to check it.			
8	I check the cable, plug and casing for damage and follow the society's inspection/testing arrangements. I do not use damaged equipment.			
9	I route and secure the cable as the manual directs and never cut towards it. I never use the machine in rain or on wet grass.			
10	I unplug the machine before clearing a jam, adjusting or changing anything.			
11	I check that the battery is the right model and clicks home, and that its casing and contacts are clean and dry.			
12	I take the battery OUT before clearing a jam, adjusting or changing the cutting attachment.			

Electric hedge cutter - continued

#	SAFE-USE POINT - on the actual machine	Covered	N/A	More help
	USING IT			
13	I use the two-hand control with both hands on both handles at all times. I never defeat the switch or use the machine one-handed.			
14	I do not use ladders, steps or water butts. If I cannot reach from the ground, I do not use this tool for the job.			
15	I keep the blade below shoulder height and away from my body and legs, and cut moving away from me.			
	STOPPING AND RETURNING			
16	I isolate the machine (unplug it or take the battery out) and wait for the blades to stop before clearing a blockage, moving between areas or putting it down. I never leave it running unattended.			
17	I isolate the machine before cleaning. I clean and store it dry as the manual directs, using the recommended methods.			
18	I report any damage or unusual behaviour, tag the machine OUT OF USE and make sure it is logged.			
19	I have had the emergency arrangements explained to me and know how to get first aid and summon help (see 'Using this checklist').			
20	I put the blade cover on when carrying the machine and when it is in the store.			

MY OUTCOME AND AGREED LIMITS

☐ I am ready for the agreed use ☐ I need more help - no solo use

I record the outcome agreed during my induction. If any applicable point needs more help, I do not use the tool alone.

My agreed task / limits / help needed (including reasons for N/A answers):

MY DECLARATION

I have read and understood the machine's instructions, with help if needed, and practised the essentials. I will use the required PPE, follow the agreed limits, stop if unsure and report faults or concerns.

MY SIGNATURE **DATE**

Emergency arrangements: If someone is injured, I stop and make the area safe without putting myself at risk. I get first aid; I call 999 or 112 for serious injury and arrange access for responders. I report accidents and near misses to the Tool Librarian.

I keep this completed record. I revisit my induction after a relevant change, incident, concern or a long gap in use, and ask for further help where needed. Before every use, I check the machine and working area and stop if I am unsure.

For an emailed copy and RVAS Drive storage, I submit my answers through the online form at rvas.co.uk/tool-library/. Submitting a form does not itself authorise solo use. For help or a correction: rvascontact@gmail.com.